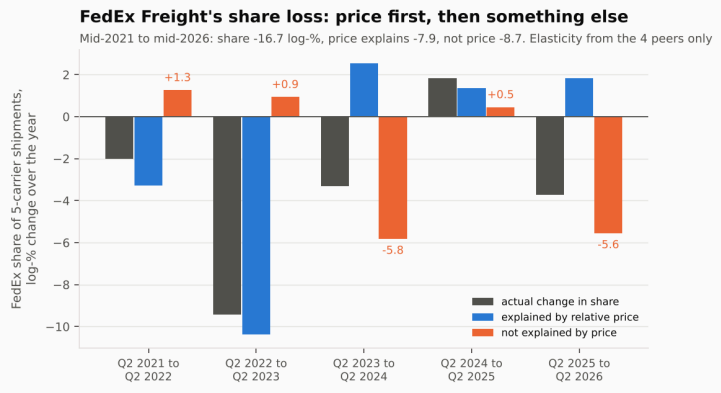
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Market or share? What explains FedEx Freight's lost volume

FedEx Freight's share of daily shipments among the five largest public LTL carriers fell **−16.7 log-%** from mid-2021 to mid-2026. I asked how much of that is price, using only public SEC filings and a method written down before any model was fitted.

Three findings



1. **Price explains −7.9 of the −16.7 log-points.** I estimated share's response to relative price on the four competitors only (elasticity −0.65; placebo p = 0.015) and applied it to FedEx out of sample. It accounts for the 2022–23 loss, when FedEx raised relative price ~10%.
2. **−8.7 is not price.** FedEx lost share in the year after Yellow's shutdown and in the year to mid-2026 while its relative price was *falling*. That points to account retention (bundle unwinding, the spin-off), not pricing.
3. **Simple beats fancy here.** Over 90 out-of-sample carrier-quarters, a carrier's own in-quarter data cut error 43% vs naive (p = 0.001); machine learning added 12 to 22%, not significant. The value of FedEx's daily data is at the account level.

A forecast locked before the answer exists

−6.0%

FedEx Freight shipments per day, June–September 2026 vs 2025 (80% range −11.2% to −2.0%). FedEx Freight reports October 29. For comparison, BofA's estimate is −3.0%.

Peers, Q3 2026: ODFL −2.4% · SAIA +0.9% · XPO +5.5% · ARCB −3.7%. Forecast file SHA-256 256eee154fe9… committed in e4e6b9d before any of them report.

What I would build first with FedEx Freight's data

Pricing	Account- and lane-level price response: which customers are price-sensitive and which are leaving for non-price reasons, with the 2.1:1 price-to-volume exchange rate as a guardrail.
Fuel	FedEx realizes 0.59× its published fuel surcharge; at EIA's 2027 diesel forecast, fuel alone takes 7.7% off revenue per shipment.
Retention	Account-level share early warning: expected weekly shipments per account, drift flagged before churn, ranked by volume at risk. One point of shipments ≈ $21M operating income a year.

More detail

2-minute video: Koppolu_FedEx_Freight_overview.mp4 · Two-page brief: Koppolu_FedEx_Freight_Market_or_Share.pdf · Code, pre-registration, model card and 31 automated tests: github.com/kstc707/job-search (fedex_freight_project).
Sources: SEC EDGAR (FedEx, FDXF, ODFL, SAIA, XPO, ARCB), FRED, BTS/ORNL FAF5.7.1, EIA, fedexfreight.com fuel table. Charts generated in Python. Limits: 90 test carrier-quarters; five public carriers are a sample of LTL; no FedEx internal data. Independent work, not affiliated with FedEx, not investment advice.